

Amma Website Roadmap

Suraiya Anvery Quilting Portfolio

1. Project Purpose

This website is a quilting portfolio for Suraiya Anvery. It is being built as a gift and as a long-term archive of her creative work.

The site should prioritize:

- Timeless design over trends
- Simplicity over unnecessary complexity
- Accessibility by default
- Performance over heavy visual effects
- Clean, maintainable code

Suraiya's approval is required before any meaningful public content or design changes go live. Nothing significant should be published without her review.

2. Current Completed Foundation

The following has been completed as of the time of this document:

- Stable Git workflow using feature branches, with `main` as the always-deployable branch
- Work archive folder structure created under `assets/images/work/`
- Quilt image archive normalized: 26 quilt folders, all lowercase kebab-case
- Images optimized from roughly 2.7 GB to roughly 621 MB using Python/Pillow (quality 85, max 2000px wide for main images, max 2400px wide for detail images)
- Raw image backup preserved outside the repo at a local source folder
- `.DS\_Store` files ignored via `.gitignore`
- `content/work-inventory.md` exists as the planning and inventory source of truth
- `content/image-guidelines.md` exists documenting image conventions
- `content/writeups/quilts/` folder exists for write-up drafts
- Four quilt write-ups have source PDFs and extracted Markdown drafts:
 - Daniyaal's Childhood – A Visual Narrative
 - Rings of Terracotta
 - Stories of Love
 - Zikr Series: Evening Tea in the Indoor Veranda

- Zikr naming mismatch corrected: slug and folder renamed from ``zikr-series-quiet-hours-of-the-morning`` to ``zikr-series-evening-tea-in-the-indoor-veranda``
 - Visible website redesign has not yet started from this content archive
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3. Guiding Principles

- **Suraiya approves before anything goes public.** She should review and sign off on design decisions, page content, and category structure before any changes are deployed.
 - **Timeless design over trends.** The site should feel calm, considered, and professional — not fashionable in a way that ages badly.
 - **Simplicity over complexity.** Do not add systems, frameworks, or features before they are genuinely needed.
 - **Performance by default.** Optimized images, fast load times, no unnecessary JavaScript.
 - **Accessibility by default.** Semantic HTML, proper alt text, readable contrast ratios, keyboard navigation.
 - **Desktop and mobile both matter.** The site must work well across all screen sizes.
 - **Clean, maintainable code.** Prefer readable CSS and HTML over clever shortcuts.
 - **Preserve source images outside the repo.** Only commit optimized, website-ready images.
 - **Do not over-engineer.** Three similar lines of code is better than a premature abstraction.
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4. Phase 1 – Content Archive and Inventory

Status: Mostly complete.

Completed

- Work folder structure created under ``assets/images/work/``
- Quilt image folders created and normalized (26 quilts)
- Images optimized for web delivery
- ``content/work-inventory.md`` tracking all known works
- Source PDFs stored in ``content/writeups/quilts/source-pdfs/``
- Markdown write-up drafts extracted for four quilts
- Zikr naming corrected throughout the archive

Remaining

- Final audit of the content archive after all current PRs are merged
 - Choose one main image for ``khalas-quilts`` (currently has ``main-1.jpg`` and ``main-2.jpg``)
 - Choose one main image for ``tashas-embrace`` (currently has ``main-1.jpg`` and ``main-2.jpg``)
 - Add remaining quilts as Suraiya provides them
 - Add future write-up PDFs and extract Markdown drafts as they become available
 - Add size and time-to-make metadata to the inventory where available
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5. Phase 2 – Navigation and Work Overview

This is the next phase of visible website work.

Navigation Changes

- Update Work navigation so that "Work" is a hover-only desktop heading, not a normal clickable link
- On desktop: hovering or focusing "Work" opens the dropdown
- On mobile: tapping "Work" expands or collapses the submenu
- Work dropdown categories:
 - Quilts
 - Bags
 - Pouches
 - Table Runners
 - Everyday Essentials
- Consider adding Exhibitions as a separate main navigation item (separate from the Work dropdown)
- Remove old labels: All Work, Small Works, Wall Hangings (as a top-level item), Runners

Work Overview Page

- Replace the old "All Work" gallery with a Work overview page built from category cards
 - One card per Work category:
 - Quilts
 - Bags
 - Pouches
 - Table Runners
 - Everyday Essentials
 - Each category card should include:
 - One representative image
 - Category title
 - Short category description (needs Suraiya's input)
 - Link or button to that category page
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6. Phase 3 – Quilts Category Page

- Build a Quilts grid page listing individual quilts
- Layout: rows of three on desktop; mobile-friendly responsive layout
- Each quilt card should show:
 - Main image
 - Title
 - Size (if available)
 - Time to make (if available)
- If metadata fields are missing, hide them gracefully rather than showing placeholder text

- Display the first 6 quilts by default; "See more" reveals 3 additional quilts at a time
 - Only link a quilt card to a detail page when a detail/write-up page exists — unless placeholder pages are explicitly approved by Suraiya
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7. Phase 4 – Individual Quilt Pages

Start with the four quilts that already have write-up drafts:

1. Daniyaal's Childhood – A Visual Narrative
2. Rings of Terracotta
3. Stories of Love
4. Zikr Series: Evening Tea in the Indoor Veranda

Page Structure

Each individual quilt page should include:

- Main image (full-width or large featured)
- Title
- Size and time-to-make metadata (if available)
- Suraiya's write-up text
- Detail image gallery
- Back to Quilts link

Design Direction

- Editorial feeling, calm and considered — similar in spirit to thoughtful quilt blog pages, but simpler and aligned with the Amma website design language
 - Create a reusable detail page pattern that can be applied to future works with minimal effort
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8. Phase 5 – Bags, Pouches, Table Runners, Everyday Essentials

- Build a Bags category page using the same grid logic as Quilts
 - Build a Pouches page once titles and types are finalized with Suraiya
 - Build a Table Runners page — note: consider whether Zikr Series: Evening Tea in the Indoor Veranda belongs under Table Runners rather than (or in addition to) Quilts
 - Build an Everyday Essentials page; consider possible subgroups:
 - Wall hangings
 - Coasters
 - Book sleeves
 - Jewelry pouches
 - Do not build complex product or shop behavior until Suraiya has approved the overall structure and scope
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9. Phase 6 – Featured Works

- The homepage Featured Works section should display three selected pieces
 - Each card should include:
 - Main image
 - Title
 - One short extra field (chosen by Suraiya — e.g. a short quote, a note about materials, or occasion)
 - A "Continue Reading" or "View Work" button
 - The three featured works are subject to change at Suraiya's discretion
 - Good initial candidates are the four works with completed write-ups, but Suraiya should make the final selection
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10. Phase 7 – Shop / Availability / Commissions

- Clarify what "Shop" should mean before building anything
 - Possible Version 1 direction: an Available Works page or a Commission Inquiry form
 - Avoid full ecommerce for now; it adds significant complexity and maintenance burden
 - Future possibilities (to be decided with Suraiya):
 - Available works listing
 - Commission inquiry form
 - Patterns for sale
 - Workshops or classes
 - Online shop (if demand warrants it)
 - Testimonials
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11. Phase 8 – QA, Review, and Approval

Before anything goes live publicly, the following should be completed:

- Desktop QA across browsers
 - Mobile QA across devices
 - Navigation QA (hover, tap, keyboard)
 - Image loading and performance review
 - Accessibility review (alt text, contrast, keyboard navigation)
 - Broken link check
 - Netlify deploy preview review
 - Prepare review materials for Suraiya
 - Suraiya approves the site before public deployment
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12. Long-Term Roadmap

The following are future possibilities, to be considered as the site grows:

- Individual pages for all works across all categories

- Exhibitions section documenting public shows and community art events
 - Process stories or behind-the-scenes write-ups
 - Blog or journal posts
 - Workshops or class listings
 - Pattern sales
 - Online shop (if appropriate)
 - Testimonials
 - Search and filtering for the work archive
 - Consider migrating to a static site generator (e.g. Eleventy or Astro) if the hand-maintained HTML becomes hard to scale
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13. Recommended Immediate Next Steps

1. Sync `main` locally after all current PRs are merged
 2. Run a full content archive audit — verify all 26 quilt folders, confirm inventory matches filesystem
 3. Resolve main image selection for `khalas-quilts` and `tashas-embrace`
 4. Build updated Work navigation (hover dropdown, mobile expand/collapse) and Work overview category cards
 5. Build the Quilts grid category page
 6. Build the first four individual quilt detail pages using the write-up drafts already in place
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14. Open Questions / Decisions Needed From Suraiya

- **Category descriptions** — Short descriptions for each Work category card (Quilts, Bags, Pouches, Table Runners, Everyday Essentials)
- **Featured Works selection** — Which three works should appear on the homepage?
- **Zikr classification** — Does Zikr Series: Evening Tea in the Indoor Veranda belong under Quilts, Table Runners, or both?
- **Size and time-to-make metadata** — Can Suraiya provide or confirm these for the 26 quilts?
- **Main image choices** — Final selection between `main-1.jpg` and `main-2.jpg` for `khalas-quilts` and `tashas-embrace`
- **Works without write-ups** — Should quilt cards link to pages even when no write-up is available, or only when a write-up exists?
- **Shop and commission scope** — What should the Shop or Commissions section look like, and when?
- **Exhibitions** — Are there past or upcoming exhibitions to document?